

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

Weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know

Saturday, 8 August 2026 • GMT+8 (Hong Kong)

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 7 August 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

1 • Weekly Market Snapshot

Instrument	Fri close	Week	YTD	Note
S&P 500	7,757.64	+3.6%	+13.3%	Record closing high; 2nd straight up week
Nasdaq Composite	26,690.62	+5.2%	+14.8%	Chip/AI bounce led; testing top of range
Dow Jones	54,036.93	+3.0%	+12.4%	Financials logged 14 new highs
UST 10-Year	4.65%	-10 bp	+47 bp	Yields fell as hike fears eased
UST 2-Year	4.19%	-9 bp	+72 bp	2s10s +46 bp, a touch steeper
Dollar (DXY)	≈99.98	~flat	softer	Near a 7-week low; bearish TREND
Gold (spot)	\$4,399.7	+7.1%	+1.4%	Bullish breakout (TRADE & TREND)
Silver (spot)	\$63.50	+9.9%	-10.1%	Outran gold on the week
Brent crude	\$83.55	-5.0%	+37.3%	Down on week; Fri bounce on Hormuz
WTI crude	≈\$77.2	≈-5%	up	Tracks Brent; wk % approx.
Bitcoin	\$64,883	+3.3%	-25.9%	Bounced; still the YTD laggard

Levels are Friday 7 Aug closes. Index/Treasury/gold/silver/Brent/Bitcoin moves computed Fri-to-Fri from primary data; DXY and WTI weekly moves are approximate (see Sources).

2 • TL;DR

Bad news was good news. A shock -23k July payrolls print (vs +83k expected) flipped the Fed conversation from 'will they hike?' to 'hold, maybe cut,' and stocks ripped to record highs — **S&P +3.6%, Nasdaq +5.2%**, led by mega-cap software and a chip-sector bounce. Yields and the dollar softened, **gold broke out (+7.1%)**, and Hedgeye stayed in **#Quad3** — but with the tape now testing the top of its range and inflation still hot, this is a chase you fade, not follow.

3 • The Big Picture — What the Week Meant

1. A weak jobs print, not strong growth, powered the melt-up

July nonfarm payrolls fell 23,000 — the first outright decline in months and a big miss vs. the +83k consensus — with government payrolls down 53,000 and wage growth cooling to +3.2% y/y (slowest since May 2021). The unemployment rate ticked to 4.1%. Equities rallied precisely because the data was soft.

Read: This is a defensive rally dressed as an offensive one. You are buying easing-hope, not accelerating earnings — own what wins when growth slows and policy softens (gold, quality software, healthcare), not deep-cyclical beta.

2. The Fed debate flipped from hikes to holds

Out of the end-July FOMC (held at 3.50%–3.75% under Chair Kevin Warsh), futures had priced a real chance of a September HIKE on sticky inflation. The jobs miss gutted that: CME FedWatch moved to ~60% for a hold (from ~45% a day earlier and ~33% a week earlier), Kalshi put a hold at ~65%, and Polymarket even flirts with a 25 bp September cut (~51%).

Read: Front-end yields did the work — 2s -9 bp, 10s -10 bp. The pain trade is now a dovish surprise; lean toward a steeper curve and stay humble about the 'higher-for-longer re-hike' thesis that dominated a week ago.

3. Software and memory led; semiconductors were the fault line

Microsoft (Azure +43% y/y, cloud past a \$100B annual run-rate) and SanDisk (NAND upcycle) were rewarded; AMD beat (revenue +50%, data-center +107%) yet fell on a lofty bar, and Palantir posted +81% revenue growth but dropped on 'agentic-AI eats SaaS' fears. Nvidia rallied +12.9% into its 26 Aug print.

Read: Leadership is narrowing to software and memory, not blanket semis. Reaction, not results, is the tell — when blowouts sell off (AMD, PLTR), the bar is the risk. Respect single-name Signals over the 'AI' label.

4. Gold broke out while Bitcoin stayed broken

Gold jumped +7.1% to ~\$4,400 in a textbook bullish phase transition (higher-lows, repeated higher-highs, TRADE and TREND breakouts); silver ran +9.9%. Bitcoin bounced +3.3% but is still -25.9% YTD — the standout risk-asset laggard of 2026.

Read: In #Quad3 (growth slowing, inflation sticky), real-asset stores of value beat digital beta. Gold is Hedgeye's #1 Quad3 allocation; crypto's YTD drawdown says the marginal risk dollar is rotating toward hard assets.

5. Volatility got crushed — and that is the catch

VIX fell to 14.9, off the ~20.7 spike of late July, as the tape melted up. Credit is priced for perfection: IG spreads ~77 bp (bottom decile since the GFC) and HY OAS ~2.7% (vs. a 20-year ~4.9% average). Hedgeye flags 8 of 9 major Risk Ranges with more downside than upside.

Read: Cheap vol + record-tight credit + an extended tape = asymmetric downside. This is the level to buy protection, not to add unhedged length.

6. Beneath the calm, a Korean semiconductor unwind is a warning

Even as US indices printed records, the KOSPI crash deepened to -31.3% and Hedgeye stayed short semis (DRAM) and South Korea (EWY). Global dispersion is widening beneath a placid US headline.

Read: Index records can mask violent single-market/single-factor drawdowns. Keep the book long-short within sectors (e.g., long software vs. short semis) rather than betting the beta.

4 • Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

The weak jobs print pulled the whole curve lower: the 10-year fell ~10 bp to 4.65% and the 2-year ~9 bp to 4.19%, leaving 2s10s at +46 bp (modestly steeper). Both sit well above end-2025 levels (10Y +47 bp, 2Y +72 bp YTD) — 2026 has been a higher-yield regime on sticky inflation. Credit is priced for perfection: IG OAS ~77 bp (bottom-decile tight) and HY OAS ~2.7%, far inside the 20-year ~4.9% average, with new IG deals reportedly ~5x oversubscribed.

Read: Own duration for the growth-scare, not the carry; in credit, you are not paid to reach — up-in-quality and let the spread-widening asymmetry come to you.

Currencies

The dollar (DXY ~100) drifted near a seven-week low and Hedgeye holds a bearish immediate-term TREND (99.01-100.71). Softer front-end yields and receding hike odds took the wind out of the greenback into the jobs number.

Read: A rolling-over dollar is the quiet tailwind under gold, non-US equities and EM. Keep a soft-USD tilt while the Fed leans dovish-of-hikes.

Commodities

Gold stole the show, +7.1% to ~\$4,399/oz on a clean bullish breakout, with silver +9.9%. Energy went the other way: Brent fell ~5.0% to \$83.55 (WTI ~\$77) as US-Iran/Hormuz de-escalation hopes advanced mid-week, before a Friday bounce on renewed Strait-of-Hormuz tension. Brent is still +37.3% YTD — the war-and-Hormuz risk premium that has defined 2026 oil.

Read: Precious metals are the cleanest Quad3 longs. Oil is a headline machine around Hormuz — trade the range (Hedgeye WTIC 72.63–82.60, bearish TREND), don't marry a direction.

5 • Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Regime: #Quad3 (growth slowing, inflation accelerating). Hedgeye's favored longs are Gold (its #1 Quad3 allocation), Healthcare (XLV), Software/Tech (XLK — explicitly not semis), REITs (XLRE) and Energy (XLE); the book is short Semis/DRAM and South Korea (EWY). Source: Early Look, '#Quad3 Longs: Gold, Healthcare, etc.,' 7 Aug 2026 (Keith McCullough).

Immediate-term Risk Range™ Signals — 7 Aug 2026

Instrument	Immediate-term range	TREND
UST 10Y Yield	4.59 – 4.74	BULLISH
High Yield (HYG)	78.95 – 79.70	BULLISH
IG Corp Bonds (LQD)	105.4 – 107.1	BEARISH
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,375 – 7,826	BULLISH
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	24,441 – 26,701	BULLISH
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,901 – 3,058	BULLISH
Technology (XLK)	174 – 190	BULLISH
Healthcare (XLV)	160 – 168	BULLISH
Real Estate (XLRE)	44.40 – 46.20	BULLISH
Volatility (VIX)	14.74 – 17.88	BEARISH
US Dollar (DXY)	99.01 – 100.71	BEARISH
WTI Crude (WTIC)	72.63 – 82.60	BEARISH
Nat Gas (NATGAS)	2.55 – 2.79	BEARISH
Gold (spot)	4,103 – 4,331	BULLISH
Copper (spot)	6.40 – 6.85	BULLISH
Silver (spot)	57 – 66	NEUTRAL

Where we sit

The TREND is bullish across US equity benchmarks, but the tape is stretched: the Nasdaq closed 26,691 against the very top of its range (26,701), the S&P (7,758) sits near its 7,826 ceiling, and Hedgeye's MOMO Tracker flags 8 of 9 Risk Ranges with downside > upside. Gold has broken above the top of its stated range (4,331) — confirming the phase transition — while VIX (bearish TREND) and the dollar (bearish) are cooperating with risk. Net: bullish TREND, poor immediate-term reward/risk at these levels.

Read: Buy the low end of ranges, trim the high end. With indices pinned to their ceilings, add through Quad3 winners (gold, software, healthcare, REITs) on pullbacks rather than chasing the benchmark here.

6 • Mag7 Scoreboard

Company	Price	Week	YTD	Mkt cap	P/E (TTM)
NVIDIA (NVDA)	\$223.96	+12.9%	+20.1%	\$5.42T	34.1×
Apple (AAPL)	\$313.33	+2.8%	+15.3%	\$4.60T	35.8×
Alphabet (GOOGL)	\$354.30	+4.0%	+13.2%	\$4.29T	17.6×
Microsoft (MSFT)	\$499.99	+11.1%	+3.4%	\$3.71T	27.8×
Amazon (AMZN)	\$274.48	+3.6%	+18.9%	\$2.95T	21.8×
Meta (META)	\$592.10	+8.9%	-10.3%	\$1.51T	22.0×

Company	Price	Week	YTD	Mkt cap	P/E (TTM)
Tesla (TSLA)	\$328.58	+6.1%	-26.9%	\$1.30T	~279×

Leadership read: a software-and-silicon week. Microsoft (+11.1%) and Nvidia (+12.9%) did the heavy lifting, with Meta (+8.9%) and Tesla (+6.1%) joining the bounce; Apple (+2.8%) and Amazon (+3.6%) lagged. The YTD spread tells the real story — Nvidia (+20%), Amazon (+19%) and Apple (+15%) lead, while Meta (-10%) and Tesla (-27%) remain the group's problem children. Valuations are bifurcated: Alphabet screens cheapest at 17.6× and is the only 'value' name in the cohort; Tesla's ~279× keeps it in a category of one.

Read: Don't buy 'the Mag7' — buy the dispersion. The tape is rewarding earnings power (MSFT, NVDA) and re-rating a cheap compounder (GOOGL) while punishing story stocks (TSLA). Concentration risk is real: a handful of names still drive the bulk of index moves.

7 • Positioning & Options

Volatility collapsed alongside the melt-up: VIX ended at 14.9, down ~7% on the week and well below the ~20.7 late-July spike, with Hedgeye holding a bearish VIX TREND (14.74–17.88). Credit remains priced for perfection — IG OAS ≈77 bp (bottom-decile tight) and HY OAS ≈2.7% (well inside the ~4.9% 20-year average) — and Hedgeye scores HYG a bullish TREND (78.95–79.70) versus a bearish LQD (105.4–107.1): spread/carry favored over duration-heavy IG.

Read: Net read: calm is the commodity to buy. Sub-15 VIX and record-tight credit make hedges cheap into an extended tape and a data-dependent Fed — fund downside protection now, while it is on sale.

8 • Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

Technology (~+7.2%) and Materials (~+4.8%) led the week, with Communication Services close behind and Financials contributing the largest count of new highs (14). Energy lagged as crude fell. The rotation fits the regime: money is broadening into rate-sensitive and real-asset-linked groups (materials/miners, REITs) even as software carries tech.

Read: Hedgeye read: leadership is rotating within #Quad3 toward Gold, Healthcare, Software, REITs and Energy — and away from Semis (short DRAM) and South Korea (short EWY). Play tech through software, not chips; add REITs and healthcare as the growth-slowing/dovish mix broadens participation.

9 • Corporate News — Earnings & Events

- **Microsoft** — blowout quarter: Azure revenue +43% y/y and cloud past a \$100B annual run-rate for the first time; shares extended a post-earnings surge (+11.1% on the week).
- **AMD** — beat and raised (revenue +50%, data-center +107%) but shares fell on an elevated bar, briefly rattling semis.
- **Palantir (PLTR)** — revenue ~\$1.81B (+81% y/y), EPS +119% to ~\$0.35 — a blowout that still sold off on 'agentic AI eats SaaS' fears.
- **SanDisk (SNDK)** — blowout FQ4; shares soared on the NAND/memory upcycle.
- **Shopify (SHOP)** — +16% on a 'monster quarter': revenue +34% y/y to \$3.58B, EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.40 est.
- **Eli Lilly (LLY)** — surged on continued GLP-1 demand.
- **Disney (DIS)** — raised its FY26 buyback target to ≥\$9B and reiterated ~12% adjusted EPS growth; parks strong. Uber and CVS also beat.
- **Nvidia (NVDA)** — reports 26 Aug — the next big AI catalyst. China H2O licenses remain in case-by-case review (25% import tariff, 50% volume cap).

10 • Macro Data — Key Releases

- **US July payrolls (7 Aug):** -23,000 vs +83k expected (first drop in months); government -53k; unemployment 4.1%; average hourly earnings +3.2% y/y (slowest since May 2021). **Net:** the labor market is cracking — the dominant dovish catalyst of the week.

- **US ISM Manufacturing, July (1 Aug):** headline at its highest since May 2022 (robust activity), but prices/inflation worries described as 'worse than the pandemic era.' **Net:** growth-hot, inflation-hotter — textbook #Quad3 tension.
- **Fed policy:** held at 3.50%–3.75% at end-July (Chair Kevin Warsh) after leaning toward a possible hike; post-jobs, hike odds collapsed. **Net:** the base case is a September hold, with a minority now pricing a cut.
- **Rates market:** 2Y –9 bp to 4.19%, 10Y –10 bp to 4.65%. **Net:** bonds are trading the growth scare, not the inflation problem.

11 • Geopolitics

- **Russia–Ukraine:** Trump's ultimatum (50 days → 10 days) expired 8 Aug with no ceasefire; envoy Steve Witkoff met Putin on 6 Aug, the US layered secondary sanctions on India over Russian-oil purchases (~7 Aug), and Trump held off further measures citing live talks. A Trump–Putin summit is expected soon (UAE floated as venue). The Graham 'Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026' — up to 100% tariffs on buyers of Russian energy — cleared an 86–12 procedural vote but stalled over its tariff-authority provisions.
- **Middle East / oil:** The Strait of Hormuz crisis (a legacy of the early-2026 US–Israel–Iran conflict) kept oil headline-driven. Iran and Oman are near a commercial-shipping framework and a US–Iran draft is circulating (via Qatar), but Houthi attack claims (Saudi tanker, 5 Aug) and fresh Hormuz tension gave crude a Friday bounce.
- **Prediction markets:** Polymarket ~51% for a 25 bp September Fed cut and ~89% for zero cuts across full-year 2026; Kalshi ~65% for a September hold. The crowd sees the hike risk gone but is not yet convinced of an easing cycle.

12 • Beyond the Markets — Also Worth Knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

Two set-pieces loom: a possible Trump–Putin summit (UAE floated) tied to the Ukraine deadline, and the Fed's Jackson Hole Economic Symposium later in August — the next venue for Chair Warsh to frame the 'hold vs. hike vs. cut' debate now that the labor market is softening.

Science & frontier research

Physicists showed heat can travel through a crystal in focused, wave-like rays at room temperature (a potential thermal-management breakthrough); geophysicists reported Earth's molten iron core reversed flow direction beneath the Pacific; and biomedicine notched wins — a wearable patch cut time-to-REM sleep by ~43 minutes, and blocking the glycine transporter SLC6A20 improved autism-related behaviors in mouse models.

Space & frontier tech

On SpaceX's 4 Aug call, Elon Musk said Starship's next flight (tentatively end-August) will attempt its first orbital mission — deploying Starlink V3 satellites and, for the first time, catching the upper stage back at the launch site. NASA and Northrop Grumman (6 Aug) said they would repurpose Gateway elements for Moon Base demonstration missions; Falcon 9 kept its cadence (AST SpaceMobile BlueBird ×3, Starlink ×24).

Weather & climate (market-moving)

The 2026 North American heat wave had caused ~70 deaths by 5 August, straining grids and cutting power to hundreds of thousands, with more Plains/Rockies heat forecast and record wildfires across Europe — a live input for power demand, natural gas and agriculture. A developing El Niño may, however, temper Atlantic hurricane activity.

Water cooler (sport, screen, games)

Hollywood printed a record: 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' (a historic ~\$355M opening the prior weekend) plus 'The Odyssey' drove the biggest collective box-office weekend ever (~\$430M). On the calendar: the MLB pennant race and US Open tennis, UFC 330, F1's return from summer break (Dutch GP, 21–23 Aug), and the WNBA playoff push. In games, Game Freak's sci-fi RPG 'Beast of Reincarnation' headlines August, alongside 'Star Wars Zero Company' and 'Hell Let Loose: Vietnam.'

13 • Appendix — Stock Cards

Compact cards for names materially discussed above. Prices are 7 Aug closes; market cap, P/E (TTM), dividend and 52-week range from primary data. Six-month trend described in words.

NVIDIA — NVDA

\$223.96 • Wk +12.9% • YTD +20.1% • Mkt cap \$5.42T • P/E 34.1× • Div 0.13% • 52-wk \$164.07–\$236.54

6-mo trend: Up sharply off the spring lows; reclaimed the highs this week and now within ~6% of its 52-week peak.

Read: *World's largest company and the AI bellwether; 26 Aug earnings and China H2O licensing are the swing factors. Hedgeye prefers software to semis — respect the dispersion.*

Microsoft — MSFT

\$499.99 • Wk +11.1% • YTD +3.4% • Mkt cap \$3.71T • P/E 27.8× • Div 0.71% • 52-wk \$349.20–\$553.72

6-mo trend: Range-bound most of 2026, then a sharp earnings-driven surge in late July/early August back toward record territory.

Read: *Azure +43% and a \$100B cloud run-rate reset the narrative. The week's cleanest large-cap breakout and the leader of the software-over-semis trade.*

Apple — AAPL

\$313.33 • Wk +2.8% • YTD +15.3% • Mkt cap \$4.60T • P/E 35.8× • Div 0.34% • 52-wk \$219.25–\$344.57

6-mo trend: Steady grind higher through 2026; consolidating just below its 52-week high.

Read: *A defensive mega-cap that lagged the week's risk-on move. Pricey on trailing earnings; a holder, not the leader here.*

Alphabet — GOOGL

\$354.30 • Wk +4.0% • YTD +13.2% • Mkt cap \$4.29T • P/E 17.6× • Div 0.24% • 52-wk \$196.60–\$408.61

6-mo trend: Big recovery off deep spring lows (near \$197) to the mid-\$350s, though still ~13% below its 52-week high.

Read: *The only 'value' Mag7 name at 17.6×. Cheapest re-rating candidate in the cohort if AI-search fears keep fading.*

Amazon — AMZN

\$274.48 • Wk +3.6% • YTD +18.9% • Mkt cap \$2.95T • P/E 21.8× • No dividend • 52-wk \$196.00–\$287.20

6-mo trend: Strong uptrend through 2026; pressing against its 52-week high.

Read: *Retail + AWS + ads flywheel intact; a core long that quietly outperformed most of the group YTD. Watch capex intensity.*

Meta Platforms — META

\$592.10 • Wk +8.9% • YTD –10.3% • Mkt cap \$1.51T • P/E 22.0× • Div 0.36% • 52-wk \$520.26–\$796.25

6-mo trend: Well off its highs (peaked ~\$796); found footing near \$520 and bounced hard this week.

Read: *A 2026 laggard on AI-capex angst, now cheap-ish at 22×. This week's move is a relief rally — needs capex discipline to re-rate.*

Tesla — TSLA

\$328.58 • Wk +6.1% • YTD –26.9% • Mkt cap \$1.30T • P/E ≈279× • No dividend • 52-wk \$297.38–\$498.83

6-mo trend: The clear mega-cap loser of 2026, down from ~\$499 to the low \$300s; sits near its 52-week low.

Read: *Bounced with the tape, but ~279× leaves no margin for error. Story stock; trade the range and size for the beta.*

Gold (spot)

≈\$4,399.7/oz • Wk +7.1% • YTD +1.4% • Hedgeye range 4,103–4,331 (bullish)

6-mo trend: Wild year: spiked toward ~\$5,300 in Q1, corrected to ~\$4,000, and is now breaking out again to the mid-\$4,300s+.

Read: *Hedgeye's #1 Quad3 allocation and a textbook bullish phase transition. The cleanest expression of growth-slowness + sticky-inflation.*

Bitcoin — BTC

≈\$64,883 • Wk +3.3% • YTD –25.9%

6-mo trend: Down from ~\$95k in January to a June trough near ~\$58k; grinding a recovery back toward the mid-\$60s.

Read: *The risk-asset laggard of 2026. A bounce within a downtrend; hard assets, not digital beta, are winning the store-of-value trade this year.*

Sources & Disclosures

Figures are for the week ending Friday 7 August 2026 close unless noted; verify live prices before acting. Index, Treasury, gold, silver, Brent and Bitcoin levels and Fri-to-Fri moves computed from primary market data (Financial Modeling Prep / exchange EOD); Mag7 prices, market caps, 52-week ranges, dividends and TTM P/E from the same. DXY and WTI weekly percentage moves are approximate where a clean Friday-to-Friday primary print could not be confirmed. Hedgeye Quad regime and Risk Range™ Signals from the Hedgeye Early Look 'Quad3 Longs: Gold, Healthcare, etc.' and MOMO Tracker, both dated 7 Aug 2026.

News, macro, earnings, geopolitics and beyond-markets items: CNBC, Reuters, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Kiplinger, BLS, Quartz, FX Leaders, TradingKey, Benzinga, Seeking Alpha, The Motley Fool, FXStreet, Forbes, Al Jazeera, CNN, Washington Times, Axios, Atlantic Council, Polymarket/Kalshi, Charles Schwab, Janus Henderson, SpaceNews / Spaceflight Now, US News, ScienceDaily / Science News, Wikipedia (2026 North American heat wave; 2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis), Variety and Box Office Mojo. Hedgeye Risk Management LLC for Quad/Risk Range data.

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